

**GOD
STARTS**
to make our
WORLD

MONDAY

TODAY'S GIFT

Marvel at God's
creation of light, water,
land, and plants.

MEMORY VERSE

In the beginning God
created the heavens and
the earth. Gen 1:1 NKJV

MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

Read each phrase slowly and add a simple gesture—"In the beginning..." (one finger up), "God..." (point to the sky), "created..." (hands molding), "the heavens..." (arm sweeping overhead), "and the earth..." (finger tracing the ground). Pause after each, let your children echo, then move on.



INTRODUCTION

The Wonder of Creation

The story of creation is packed with wonder and current research affirms the power of wonder. Wonder reduces our anxiety and helps us to feel peaceful, joyful, and grateful. When we experience wonder we think more creatively and show greater kindness to others. Most of all, when we look at the amazing works of God's creation, even our own hands, we have glimpses into His character of love, wisdom, creativity, and artistry.

Pause to have a slow moment of wonder with your family today. Look at your fruit and vegetables. Cut them open and appreciate the beauty of their design. Smell their fragrance, feel their textures, taste their flavors. Explore the details of a flower or leaf. Watch a bird or insect as it moves. Everything has been designed by God.

During the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus told His friends not to worry about clothes and food but to look at the flowers and birds that God has made and know that He is taking good care of us. Wonder opens the hearts of our children to God's love and helps them fall in love with Him forever. Sometimes, wonder is more powerful than a sermon in leading people to His love.

DEVOTIONAL

God Starts to Make our World

Find a candle and matches, or a flashlight; a bottle of water and glasses and some blowing bubbles; some fruits or flowers.

God's heart was overflowing with love and delight as He worked out His design for a beautiful new planet. He loved Adam and Eve already, even though He hadn't created them yet. God imagined His brand-new children living in a perfect garden filled with everything they could ever want. He chose the perfect planet. It was empty, bare, and ready for Him to fill with beautiful things!

On the first day, God visited the planet called Earth. It was very dark. So He created pure light to brighten the darkness. The

light shone like gold on the bare earth as it waited to be filled with God's wonderful creations. The light shone until nighttime, and then it was dark again. His children would enjoy seeing the beautiful light. God looked at everything He had made in love and saw that it was good.

Let's light this candle or turn on this flashlight to remind us that God created all the light we can see. **(Invite children to light the candle or flashlight.)**

On the second day, God visited the planet again. The light shone brightly as God arranged the water on the earth and made a huge bubble of water around the planet to keep it watered. The pure water sparkled in the light, and everything looked clean and fresh. His children would enjoy drinking the clear water, splashing in the rivers, and seeing the blue sky. God looked at everything He had made in love, and He saw that it was good. **(Let children drink the pure water and blow bubbles.)**

On the third day, God visited planet Earth again. This was going to be an amazing day! There was so much to do! He shaped

the earth with hills and valleys. He drew the coastline in the ocean sands. Then He covered all the earth with green and growing things. Soft, sweet grass to walk on, flowers to fragrance the air, delicious juicy fruits, and tasty nuts to eat. Tall trees, short trees, bushes, different leaves, textures, and tastes. He planted a special garden where His beloved children would live and where He would meet them every day.

They would enjoy walking on the grass, smelling the perfumed flowers, and eating

the delicious things that grew on the ground, in the bushes, and in the trees—especially the juicy, sticky mangoes! God looked at everything He had made in love, and He saw that it was good. **(Let the children look at the flowers with wonder and share the fruit with them.)**

God took great care of the new planet and everything He had made. He wanted Adam and Eve to live in a beautiful place so that everything would remind them of His great love for them.



PRAYING
TOGETHER

The Bowl of Creation Prayer

- Take a large bowl to show the empty earth.
- Place a floatable candle in the bowl (fix a small candle to a piece of wood or cork that will float. Light the candle (Day 1).
- Pour water into the bowl (Day 2).
- Add a few flowers, leaves, or other vegetation to the bowl to make a pretty feature (Day 3).
- Pray, thanking God for all kinds of lights that help us (candles, car lights, flashlights, etc.), all kinds of water features in the world (rivers, waterfalls, streams, lakes, etc.), and all kinds of flowers, fruit, trees and vegetables.

MAKING MEMORIES



Family Activities



Filled with Wonder

- Gather small treasures from nature (shells, leaves, flowers, fruit skins, feathers, etc.).
- Pick one item and study it quietly for one minute.
- Share with the family what amazed you about that creation.



Scrap Creations

- Collect clean paper scraps (magazines, newspapers, wrappers).
- Use scissors and glue to craft a paper flower, fruit, or vegetable.
- Compare your paper design to the real thing and talk about what you discovered.



Fruit Salad

- Have each person choose a favorite fruit.
- Observe its outside, then slice it open to admire the inside.
- Combine the pieces into a fruit salad (or arrange slices on plates).
- Thank God for every juicy, delicious flavor.



Beautify Your Home

- Brainstorm ways to make your home more beautiful (tidy, rearrange, display flowers).
- Use materials you already have to create a decoration.
- Hang a decorated heart or a favorite Bible verse where everyone can see it.

MONDAY AT A GLANCE

THE VERSE

In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. Gen 1:1 NKJV

THE INTRODUCTION

God's artistry shines in light, water, and plants.

THE DEVOTIONAL

Day 1: light; Day 2: water; Day 3: plants—each showing His love and care.

THE PRAYER

Thank You, Lord, for light that leads us, water that refreshes us, and plants that nourish us.

THE CONVERSATION

Which creation—light, water, or plants—speaks most of God's love to you?